

of tables that existed, but were replaced with the “terms” tables instead. categories

The categories table existed to hold category names, IDs, and descriptions. Even though categories still exist, they are now stored as terms. The database class maintains the `$wpdb->categories` property to hold the name of this deprecated table.

post2cat

The post2cat table existed as a join table to associate posts with the categories they were assigned to. This table was eliminated with the advent of the terms infrastructure. The database class maintains `$wpdb->post2cat` to hold the name of this deprecated table.

Inserting new data into MySQL

To insert data into MySQL, you can safely use the `insert()` method. This method takes three arguments: the table name, an array of column/value pairs, and an optional format array (%s or %d) that will force the data to be either a string or number.

The data that is going to be inserted does not need to be sanitized, and in fact, should be “raw” — that is, unescaped. WordPress will handle all the heavy lifting on this.

Using the `insert()` method to insert a post with a possible custom post type, mp3

```
function add_music_post( $music_title, $music_description
)
{
global $wpdb;
$wpdb->insert( $wpdb->posts, array( 'post_title' => $music_title,
'post_content' => $music_description, 'post_type' => 'mp3' ), array( '%s', '%s', '%s' ) );
}
```

8.4 Updating data in MySQL safely

A second data insertion method is the `update()` method. This method, like the `insert()` method, is intended to make the process of changing data in MySQL a safe process free of SQL injection. It carries a similar format as the `insert()` method but adds a few additional arguments.

The first argument is the table name, the second argument is an array